## Airline Focus

### Interview with Magda Fisk, CEO of Corjetz

Taking over from Eric Madson as CEO of Corjetz was never going to be easy for Magda Fisk. Although the brothers had built strong foundations for the success of Corjetz, their 'entrepreneurial spirit and drive' could not maintain their early success in customer and staff satisfaction. Customer complaints and staff turnover were at their highest levels 10 years ago. Since joining, Magda has led Corjetz through a successful stock market listing, and customer satisfaction ratings hit their highest level in 20X2.

***What were your priorities when you took on the role of CEO?***

'Ten years ago, Corjetz was hierarchical and there was no connection between senior leaders and staff. I wanted staff to have autonomy to make decisions for areas which they were experts in, particularly in customer relationship management. We weren't making adequate use of the knowledge and talent that existed in the business nor were we focusing on attracting and retaining high quality staff. Our customer service approach had failed to change with the rapidly evolving external environment, so we had to trust staff to lead us on how to manage customer relationships.'

***What were the problems you had to overcome and how did you address them?***

'Leadership was centralised and there was a focus on punishment rather than reward. We were losing talented staff who felt that their voices were not being heard and were afraid to make mistakes. I introduced the monthly 'meet the board' online chats, where board members host an interactive chat on the Corjetz intranet site to highlight key initiatives in the business. This was designed to encourage communication and motivation.

We have set up staff representative committees where staff are actively encouraged to share ideas. Training programmes are constantly re-designed to ensure staff have the latest skills. I believe that empowered and engaged staff are the driver of customer service. I am proud that as an organisation we encourage open and honest dialogue between staff and leaders. Corjetz has a dynamic culture which embraces change and innovation. We even ask our cabin crew to re-design their own uniforms every four years. We hold a competition, and the most popular design is selected and professionally created. It's very popular with staff and fiercely competitive.'

***Why is the board so important to Corjetz?***

'Our non-executive directors (NEDs) play a vital role in the strategic success of the business and diversity of members is critical in such a dynamic business environment. We are fully focused on ensuring our NEDs are fully independent, to provide shareholders with the reassurance that our corporate governance is sound and robust. Diversity also extends to our executive board members, all of whom come from a wide range of backgrounds and have a depth of experience. I am also proud to be one of a growing number of female CEOs in Corland and I will continue to promote diversity in Corjetz's leadership.'